Topic 8 — Indian Languages & Literature

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Ancient Indian Literature | Sanskrit Literature | Vedic Literature | Epic Literature | Puranic Literature | Regional Literature | Indian Languages | Important Literary Works

Sources: NCERT Themes I–III, Sahitya Akademi / 8th Schedule, PIB classical-language notes, Ghatnachakra Ancient Literature and Litterateur (B–179+), UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Last verified:** September 2026

Current Affairs

- On **3 October 2024** the Union added Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali. India now has **11** classical languages.
- The Nepal–India Sanskrit Conclave of **March 2024** was held at **Kathmandu**, not Delhi.
- **Yuva Puraskar** is Sahitya Akademi's prize for writers of **35** and under. It is not Jnanpith.

8.1 Ancient Indian Literature

Ancient literature runs from Vedic oral verse through sutra and epic to classical Sanskrit. The main split is **Shruti** versus **Smriti**.

- Classical Sanskrit grammar was codified by **Panini** (पाणिनि) in the *Ashtadhyayi* (अष्टाध्यायी) (8 chapters, ~4000 sutras).
- Statecraft was expounded by **Kautilya (Chanakya)** (कौटिल्य / चाणक्य) in the *Arthashastra* (अर्थशास्त्र), followed by **Kamandaka**'s (कामंदक) *Nitisara* (नीतिसार).
- Classical Indian medical sciences were pioneered by **Charaka** (internal medicine; *Charaka Samhita* in 120 chapters and 8 sections) and **Sushruta** (surgical procedures; *Sushruta Samhita*).
- Mathematics and astronomy flourished through **Aryabhata**'s *Aryabhatiya* (place-value system, zero, Earth's rotation) and **Varahamihira**'s *Brihatsamhita* and *Panchasiddhantika*.
- Greek **Herodotus** is called the **Father of History**. His *Histories / Historica* describes Indo–Persian relations in the **5th century BCE**.
- Roman **Pliny the Elder** wrote *Natural History*. Do not match that title with **Ptolemy**.
- The *Mahabhashya* is **Patanjali**'s grammar. Yoga Sutras are a different Patanjali debate.
- Vedanga grammar companions: **Yaska** wrote *Nirukta* (etymology). **Katyayana** wrote the *Varttika* on Panini.
- The Buddhist canon language is **Pali** (Tripitaka). *Milindapanha* is **Menander / Milinda** and **Nagasena**.
- The Jain canon is Prakrit / Ardhamagadhi **Agamas**. Svetambara Angas number **12**.
- Ancient literature is not "religion only." Grammar, statecraft and Ayurveda count as ancient literature.

> **Logic:** Panini ≠ Kalidasa. Tripitaka ≠ Sanskrit. *Natural History* ≠ Ptolemy.

8.2 Sanskrit Literature

Classical Sanskrit follows Panini. It covers kavya, nataka, and shastra. Gupta age is the peak of prose and poetry.

Gupta peak & foreign mirrors

- Sanskrit literature reached a classical peak in the **Gupta** (गुप्त) age for both prose and poetry.
- High-yield Gupta-age classics include **Amarasimha**'s (अमरसिंह) *Amarakosha* (अमरकोश), **Vatsyayana**'s (वात्स्यायन) *Kamasutra* (कामसूत्र), **Kalidasa**'s (कालिदास) *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत), and **Vishakhadatta**'s (विशाखदत्त) *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस).
- *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस) is a Sanskrit drama written in the Gupta period. Its plot shows **Chandragupta Maurya** (चंद्रगुप्त मौर्य) and **Kautilya** (कौटिल्य) overthrowing the **Nandas**, and it also paints Mauryan social and economic life.
- **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) also wrote *Devichandraguptam* (देवीचन्द्रगुप्तम्) (do not assign it to **Bilhana** (बिल्हण)).

Kalidasa (highest-yield author)

Kalidasa (कालिदास) | Chandragupta II (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय) court tradition

- **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) belongs to the Chandragupta II (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय) tradition.
- The play *Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्) is his drama of Dushyanta and Shakuntala.
- The play *Malavikagnimitram* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्) is his drama of Shunga king Agnimitra and Malavika. It is often treated as his **first** play.
- The play *Vikramorvashiya* (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्) is his drama of Pururavas and Urvashi.
- The mahakavya *Raghuvamsha* (रघुवंश) is his epic of Raghu's line.
- The mahakavya *Kumarasambhava* (कुमारसंभव) is his epic of the birth of Kartikeya.
- The lyric *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत) is his cloud-messenger *khandakavya* (खंडकाव्य).
- The lyric *Ritusamhara* (ऋतुसंहार) is his cycle of the six seasons.
- These works are **not his**. *Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक) is **Bhartrihari** (भर्तृहरि). *Uttararamacharita* (उत्तररामचरित) is **Bhavabhuti** (भवभूति). *Mrichchhakatika* (मृच्छकटिकम्) is **Shudraka** (शूद्रक). *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस) is **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त). *Janakiharanam* (जानकीहरणम्) is **Kumaradasa** (कुमारदास), not Kalidasa.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q48]:** *Janakiharana* was written by **Kumaradasa** of Sri Lanka, NOT by Kalidasa. *(See Q2 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

Drama, Biography, and Court Literature

The Great Classical Dramas & Works Master Matrix

Playwright / Author	Major Works	Genre / Category	Patron / Court / Period	Protagonists, Core Theme & High-Yield Facts
Shudraka (शूद्रक)	***Mrichchhakatika*** (मृच्छकटिकम् — "The Little Clay Cart")	10-Act *Prakarana* (Social / Middle-class Drama)	Classical / Post-Gupta Era	• **Protagonists:** **Charudatta** (impoverished, noble Brahmin merchant of Ujjayini) & **Vasantasena** (wealthy, virtuous courtesan). • **Subplot:** Political revolution in Ujjayini where the rebel cowherd **Aryaka** overthrows the tyrant King Palaka. • **Key Figures:** Samsthanaka (Shakara — the wicked villain who strangles Vasantasena and frames Charudatta), Maitreya (the Vidushaka), Rohasena (Charudatta's young son who cries for a golden toy cart, filled with jewels by Vasantasena). • **Trap:** Distinct from royal heroic plays; realistically portrays thieves, gamblers, city crowds, and justice.
Vishakhadatta (विशाखदत्त)	1. ***Mudrarakshasa*** (मुद्राराक्षस — "Signet Ring of Rakshasa") 2. ***Devichandraguptam*** (देवीचन्द्रगुप्तम्)	Political Drama / Historical Play	Gupta Period (circa 5th–6th c. CE)	• *Mudrarakshasa:* **Zero female lead / romance**. Pure political espionage. Depicts **Chanakya** outwitting Rakshasa (loyal minister of the overthrown Nandas) to secure the throne for **Chandragupta Maurya**. • *Devichandraguptam:* Tragic story of cowardly king **Ramagupta** offering Queen **Dhruvadevi** to Shaka invaders, rescued by younger brother **Chandragupta II** disguised as Dhruvadevi (do not assign to Bilhana!).

Playwright / Author	Major Works	Genre / Category	Patron / Court / Period	Protagonists, Core Theme & High-Yield Facts
Bhasa (भास)	**13 Surviving Plays** (*Trivandrum Plays*, discovered in 1912 by **T. Ganapati Sastri**)	Classical Nataka & Vyayoga	Pre-Kalidasa (approx 2nd–3rd c. CE)	• ***Svapnavasavadattam*** (स्वप्नवासवदत्तम्): Love story of King **Udayana** of Vatsa (Kaushambi) and Queen **Vasavadatta** (Avanti). • ***Urubhanga*** (ऊरुभंग — "Breaking of the Thighs"): **The ONLY known tragedy in classical Sanskrit drama**, depicting Duryodhana's death on Kurukshetra. • ***Madhyama-vyayoga*** (मध्यमव्यायोग): Bhima, Hidimba & Ghatotkacha reunion. • ***Karnabhara*** (कर्णभार): Karna gifting his divine armor & earrings to disguised Indra. • ***Charudatta***: 4-act prototype later expanded by Shudraka into *Mrichchhakatika*.
Kalidasa (कालिदास)	1. ***Abhijnanashakuntalam*** (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्) 2. ***Malavikagnimitram*** (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्) 3. ***Vikramorvashiya*** (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्)	Nataka (नाटक) (Court Dramas)	Chandragupta II (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय) (Vikramaditya (विक्रमादित्य)) / Gupta Golden Age	• *Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्): King Dushyanta & Shakuntala; ring lost in Sachitirtha. • *Malavikagnimitram* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्): Kalidasa's first play; love story of Shunga King **Agnimitra** (अग्निमित्र) and princess Malavika. • *Vikramorvashiya* (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्): Vedic legend of King Pururavas and celestial nymph Urvashi.

Playwright / Author	Major Works	Genre / Category	Patron / Court / Period	Protagonists, Core Theme & High-Yield Facts
Harshavardhana (हर्षवर्धन)	1. ***Ratnavali*** (रत्नावली) 2. ***Priyadarshika*** (प्रियदर्शिका) 3. ***Nagananda*** (नागानन्द)	Sanskrit Natika & Buddhist Drama	King of Kannauj (Pushyabhuti dynasty, 606–647 CE)	• *Ratnavali:* King Udayana and Princess Ratnavali (Sagarika). • *Nagananda:* Buddhist-themed play depicting the supreme self-sacrifice of Prince **Jimutavahana** offering his own body to Garuda to save the Nagas. • Remembered as a monarch who excelled with both sword and pen.
Bhavabhuti (भवभूति)	1. ***Uttararamacharita*** (उत्तररामचरित) 2. ***Mahaviracharita*** (महावीरचरित) 3. ***Malatimadhava*** (मालतीमाधव)	Sanskrit Drama (Kavya-Nataka)	Court poet of King **Yashovarman** (यशोवर्मन) of Kannauj (8th c. CE)	• *Uttararamacharita* (उत्तररामचरित): Later life of Rama, exile of pregnant Sita, reunion with sons Lava and Kusha; acclaimed as the supreme masterpiece of the **Karuna Rasa** (करुण रस) (pathos/compassion). • *Malatimadhava* (मालतीमाधव): Passionate love of Malati & Madhava, featuring chilling tantric Aghoraghanta & Kapalika rituals in cremation grounds.
Mahendravarman I (महेन्द्रवर्मन प्रथम)	***Mattavilasa Prahasana*** (मत्तविलास प्रहसन — "The Farce of Drunken Sport")	Short Satirical Farce (*Prahasana*)	Pallava Dynasty of Kanchi (early 7th c. CE)	• Hilarious satire mocking the moral degeneration and hypocrisy of drunken **Kapalika** Shaivite ascetics, Pashupatas, and heterodox Buddhist monks in Kanchi.
Bhattanarayana (भट्टनारायण)	***Venisamhara*** (वेणीसंहार — "Braiding of the Hair")	Heroic Drama (*Nataka*)	Early Medieval (Bengal / Kannauj tradition)	• Based on the Mahabharata; depicts **Bhima** fulfilling his vow to kill Duhshasana, break Duryodhana's thighs, and braid Draupadi's dishevelled hair with their blood.

Playwright / Author	Major Works	Genre / Category	Patron / Court / Period	Protagonists, Core Theme & High-Yield Facts
Rajasekhara (राजशेखर)	1. ***Karpuramanjari*** (कर्पूरमंजरी) 2. ***Kavyamimamsa*** (काव्यमीमांसा) 3. ***Balaramayana***	Prakrit Drama & Literary Poetics	Gurjara-Pratihara court of **Mahendrapala I** & **Mahipala**	• *Karpuramanjari* is celebrated for being composed entirely in **Sauraseni Prakrit** (not Sanskrit; do not attribute to Harsha!). • *Kavyamimamsa:* Practical reference handbook on poetic craft and geography for aspiring poets.
Banabhatta (बाणभट्ट)	1. ***Harshacharita*** (हर्षचरित) 2. ***Kadambari*** (कादंबरी)	Akhyayika (Biography) & Katha (Prose Romance)	Court of King **Harsha** of Kannauj	• *Harshacharita:* First formal historical biography in Sanskrit prose. • *Kadambari:* Celebrated complex romantic novel (completed by his son Bhushanbhatta); do not confuse with Subandhu.
Jayadeva (जयदेव)	***Gita Govinda*** (गीत गोविंद)	Lyrical Devotional Poem (Giti-Kavya)	Court poet of King **Lakshmana Sena** of Bengal (12th c. CE)	• 12 Sargas and 24 Prabandhas describing the mystical divine love, separation, and union of Radha and Krishna; fundamental to Vaishnava Sahajiya and Bhakti movements.
Somadeva (सोमदेव)	1. ***Kathasaritsagara*** (कथासरित्सागर) 2. ***Lalit Vigraharaja***	Narrative Lore & Drama	Kashmir (under Ananta/Kalasha) & Chahamana court	• *Kathasaritsagara:* Massive compilation of folk tales in 18 books (*Lambakas*), adapting Gunadhya's lost *Brihatkatha* (written in Paisachi Prakrit). • *Lalit Vigraharaja:* Court drama celebrating King Vigraharaja IV (Visaladeva) of Shakambhari.

Playwright / Author	Major Works	Genre / Category	Patron / Court / Period	Protagonists, Core Theme & High-Yield Facts
Kshemendra (क्षेमेन्द्र)	***Brihatkathamanjari*** (बृहत्कथामंजरी), *Deshopadesha* (देशोपदेश), *Auchityavicharacharcha* (औचित्यविचारचर्चा)	Narrative Anthologies & Literary Criticism	11th c. Kashmir	• Famous for *Brihatkathamanjari* (बृहत्कथामंजरी) (abridgement of Brihatkatha (बृहत्कथा)) and establishing the **Auchitya** (औचित्य) (propriety) school of poetics.
Subandhu (सुबन्धु)	***Vasavadatta*** (वासवदत्ता)	Sanskrit Prose Romance	Gupta / Post-Gupta Era	• Romantic prose tale renowned for relentless double entendres (*Shlesha* — every syllable carrying two meanings); completely different book from Bhasa's play *Svapnavasavadattam*.
Bilhana (बिल्हण)	***Vikramankadevacharita*** (विक्रमांकदेवचरित)	Historical Mahakavya	Court of Western Chalukya King **Vikramaditya VI**	• Epic eulogy describing the life and triumphs of the Kalyani Chalukya king. Also wrote the famous lyrical love poem *Chaurapanchashika*.
Kamandaka (कामन्दक)	***Nitisara*** (नीतिसार)	Treatise on Statecraft & Polity	Gupta Era	• Classic political treatise based directly on Kautilya's Arthashastra; explains Mandala theory, Rajadharma, and diplomacy.

- Court-poet spine: **Chandragupta II** (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय)–**Kalidasa** (कालिदास); **Samudragupta** (समुद्रगुप्त)–**Harisena** (हरिषेण) (Allahabad prasasti); **Harsha** (हर्ष)–**Banabhatta** (बाणभट्ट); **Alauddin Khalji** (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी)–**Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो).
- **Amarasimha** (अमरसिंह) belongs to Chandragupta II's Navaratna circle. He is **not** Harshavardhana's poet.

Mahakavya from the Mahabharata

- **Sriharsha** (श्रीहर्ष) wrote *Naishadhiyacharita* (नैषधीयचरित) on **Nala and Damayanti**.
- **Bharavi** (भारवि) wrote *Kiratarjuniya* (किरातार्जुनीय) on Arjuna's combat with Shiva as a kirata.
- **Magha** (माघ) wrote *Shishupalavadha* (शिशुपालवध) on Krishna and Shishupala.
- **Dandin** (दंडी) wrote *Dashakumaracharita* (दशकुमारचरित) (adventures of ten princes) and *Kavyadarsha* (काव्यादर्श). It is **not** a Mahabharata-theme epic.

Kashmir chronicles and related histories

- **Kalhana** (कल्हण) wrote *Rajatarangini* (राजतरंगिणी), a metrical Sanskrit chronicle of the kings of **Kashmir**.
- He completed it under **Jayasimha / Jai Singh (1128–1149)**.

- The work has **eight tarangas** and thousands of verses.
- **Jonaraja** (जोनराज) continued the narrative into the Sultanate age (to Zain-ul-Abidin). His pupil **Srivara** (श्रीवर) continued after Jonaraja.
- **Vakpati** (वाकपति) wrote the Prakrit *Gaudavaho* (गौडवहो) on the digvijaya of **Yasovarman** (यशोवर्मन) of Kannauj — a historical poem often paired with *Rajatarangini* in stems.
- **Bilhana** (बिल्हण) wrote *Vikramankadevacharita* (विक्रमांकदेवचरित). **Merutunga** (मेरुतुंग) wrote *Prabandha Chintamani* (प्रबंध चिंतामणि). **Padmagupta** (पद्मगुप्त) wrote *Navasahasankacharita* (नवसाहसांकचरित) on **Paramara** (परमार) origin lore.

Science, law, and didactic texts

- **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर) wrote *Panchasiddhantika* (पंचसिद्धांतिका) (based on **Greek** astronomy), *Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता) (encyclopedic), and *Brihat Jataka* (बृहज्जातक).
- **Aryabhata** (आर्यभट) wrote *Aryabhatiya* (आर्यभटीय) covering arithmetic, algebra, plane and spherical trigonometry, and astronomy. He taught that the earth is **spherical** and **rotates** on its axis. He is often called a pioneer of trigonometry and linked with decimal place-value teaching.
- **Bhaskara II (Bhaskaracharya)** (भास्कर द्वितीय) wrote *Siddhantashiromani* (सिद्धांत शिरोमणि) in four parts: *Lilavati* (लीलावती), *Bijaganita* (बीजगणित) (algebra), *Ganitadhyaya* (गणिताध्याय), and *Goladhyaya* (गोलाध्याय). He is the usual “algebra” name in options.
- **Zero** as a numeral is credited to an **anonymous Indian**; Arabs learned it from India and used it by about **873 CE**.
- ***Manusmriti*** (*Manava Dharmashastra*) is mainly about the **social system** and law. Manu is remembered as the first law-giver of India.
- **Vijnaneshwara** (विज्ञानेश्वर) wrote the *Mitakshara* (मिताक्षरा) on Yajnavalkya Smriti. **Jimutavahana** (जीमूतवाहन) wrote the *Dayabhaga* (दायाभाग). In Mitakshara, sons can claim a right in the father’s lifetime. In Dayabhaga, the claim is generally after the father’s death.
- **Sarvavarman** wrote *Katantra* (grammar). **Devana Bhatta** wrote *Smriti Chandrika*. **Hemadri** wrote *Chaturvarga Chintamani*. **Madhavacharya** is linked with *Parashara Madhava*. **Ballala Sena** wrote *Dana Sagara*.
- *Panchatantra* (पंचतंत्र) animal fables are attributed to **Vishnu Sharma** (विष्णु शर्मा). The set is said to have been translated into about **15** Indian and **40** foreign languages. In the Mughal age **Abul Fazl** (अबुल फजल) rendered it as ***Ayar-e-Danish*** (आयारे दानिश).
- **Bharata Muni**’s (भरत मुनि) *Natyashastra* (नाट्यशास्त्र) is the treatise on drama, dance, and music — often called the “Bible” of North Indian classical music.
- **Bhamaha** (भामह) wrote *Kavyalankara* (काव्यालंकार). Do not confuse it with Bhasa’s plays.
- Pallava **Mahendravarman I** (महेन्द्रवर्मन प्रथम) wrote the farce *Mattavilasa Prahasana* (मत्तविलास प्रहसन).
- **Somadeva Suri** wrote *Nitivakyamrita*. **Nayachandra Suri** wrote *Hammira Mahakavya*.

Buddhist / Jain text traps

- *Milindapanha* is a **Pali** Buddhist dialogue of Menander and **Nagasena**. It also discusses phases of agricultural work in some stems.
- *Nettipakarana* and *Avadanashataka* are **Buddhist**.
- *Parishishtaparvan* (**Hemachandra**) and *Trishashtilakshana Mahapurana* (**Chamundaraya**) are **Jain**.

Other authors (one name, one fact)

- **Bhartrihari** (भर्तृहरि) wrote the *Niti Shataka* (नीति शतक), *Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक), and *Vairagya Shataka* (वैराग्य शतक).
- **Anandavardhana** wrote *Dhvanyaloka* on dhvani poetics.
- **Abhinavagupta** wrote *Abhinavabharati* (अभिनवभारती), the Natyashastra commentary. He is Kashmir Shaiva.
- **Surdas** wrote *Sursagar*, *Sur Saravali*, and *Sahitya Lahiri*.
- **Tulsidas** wrote *Ramcharitmanas*, *Vinaya Patrika*, and *Kavitavali*.

2025 book-match set

- **Trivikram Bhatta** wrote *Nalachampu*. Champu is mixed verse-prose.
- **Somadeva** wrote *Kathasaritsagara* in Kashmir in the 11th century. It comes from Gunadhya's *Brihatkatha*.
- **Jayadeva** wrote the *Gita Govinda*.
- **Kshemendra** wrote *Brihatkathamanjari*, also in Kashmir, as an abridgement of Brihatkatha.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q86]:** Mrichhakatikam = Shudraka; Mudrarakshasa = Vishakhadatta; Harshacharita = Banabhatta; Dashakumaracharita = Dandin. *(See Q3 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

8.3 Vedic Literature

Order of Shruti (श्रुति): Samhita (संहिता — mantra collection) → Brahmana (ब्राह्मण — ritual prose explanation) → Aranyaka (आरण्यक — forest contemplation) → Upanishad (उपनिषद् — Vedanta / philosophical realization).

Vedic Shakhas, Priests, and Texts Master Matrix

Veda	Priest (*Ritvik*)	Upaveda	Surviving Shakhas / Samhitas	Associated Brahmana	Key Upanishads & High-Yield Exam Facts
Rigveda (ऋग्वेद) *(Oldest, 1028 hymns in 10 Mandalas)*	**Hotri** (होतृ)	**Ayurveda** (medicine)	• **Shakala** (शाकल — standard extant text) • **Bashkala** (बाष्कल)	• **Aitareya** (ऐतरेय) • **Kaushitaki / Shankhayana** (कौषीतकि)	• **Aitareya Upanishad** (*Prajnanam Brahma*) • **Kaushitaki Upanishad** • *Gayatri Mantra*: Mandala 3 (Vishwamitra) • *Purusha Sukta* (origin of 4 Varnas): Mandala 10 • *Nadistuti Sukta* (rivers hymn): Mandala 10
Shukla Yajurveda *(White / Pure — verses only)*	**Adhvaryu** (अध्वर्यु)	**Dhanurveda** (archery/warfare)	• **Vajasaneyi Samhita** (वाजसनेयी) Two shakhas: 1. *Madhyandina* (North India) 2. *Kanva* (South/West India)	• **Shatapatha Brahmana** (शतपथ — 100 chapters; largest Brahmana; mentions Videha Madhava, Manu's Flood legend)	• **Isha Upanishad** (ईश — 40th chapter of Samhita itself) • **Brihadaranyaka Upanishad** (*Aham Brahmasmi*, *Tamaso Ma Jyotirgamaya*, Yajnavalkya–Maitreyi & Yajnavalkya–Gargi dialogues)

Veda	Priest (*Ritvik*)	Upaveda	Surviving Shakhas / Samhitas	Associated Brahmana	Key Upanishads & High-Yield Exam Facts
Krishna Yajurveda *(Black / Mixed — verse + prose mixed)*	**Adhvaryu** (अध्वर्यु)	**Dhanurveda** (archery/warfare)	• **Taittiriya** (तैत्तिरीय) • **Maitrayani** (मैत्रायणी) • **Kathaka / Katha** (काठक) • **Kapisthala** (कपिष्ठल)	• **Taittiriya Brahmana**	• **Taittiriya Upanishad** (*Satyam Vada, Dharmam Chara*) • **Katha Upanishad** (कठ — Yama-Nachiketa dialogue on death/soul) • **Shvetashvatara Upanishad** (first explicit mention of *Bhakti* & Rudra/Shiva) • **Maitri Upanishad**
Samaveda (सामवेद) *(Book of Chants / Indian Music root)*	**Udgatri** (उद्गातृ)	**Gandharvaveda** (music & drama)	• **Kauthuma** (कौथुम — Gujarat/Bengal) • **Ranayaniya** (राणायनीय — Maharashtra/Karnataka) • **Jaiminiya / Talavakara** (जैमिनीय — Kerala/TN)	• **Panchavimsha / Tandya** (पञ्चविंश / ताण्ड्य Maha Brahmana) • **Shadvimsha** • **Jaiminiya Brahmana**	• **Chhandogya Upanishad** (छांदोग्य — *Tat Tvam Asi*, Satyakama Jabala story, earliest mention of Devakiputra Krishna) • **Kena Upanishad** (केन)
Atharvaveda (अथर्ववेद) *(Spells, healing, charms, everyday life)*	**Brahma** (ब्रह्मा — silent chief supervisor)	**Shilpaveda** / Arthashastra	• **Shaunaka** (शौनक — standard text) • **Pippalada** (पिप्पलाद — preserved in Odisha/Kashmir)	• **Gopatha Brahmana** (गोपथ — **ONLY single Brahmana** belonging to Atharvaveda)	• **Mundaka Upanishad** (मुण्डक — *"Satyameva Jayate"* from 3.1.6) • **Mandukya Upanishad** (माण्डूक्य — shortest, 12 verses; *Ayam Atma Brahma*) • **Prashna Upanishad** (प्रश्न)

Core Concept: Why Shukla vs. Krishna Yajurveda?

- **Yajurveda** is the Veda of sacrifice formulas and procedures. It is written in **both verse and prose**.
- **Shukla Yajurveda (White / Pure):**
- Sage **Yajnavalkya** received it from the Sun God (*Surya / Vajasani*), hence named **Vajasaneyi Samhita**.
- It contains **only the mantras** (pure hymns); all ritual explanations were separated out into the **Shatapatha Brahmana**.
- Shakhas: **Madhyandina** and **Kanva**.
- **Krishna Yajurveda (Black / Mixed):**
- Associated with Sage **Vaishampayana** and disciple **Tittiri**.
- Mantras are **mixed with prose commentary and ritual explanations** in the same text.
- Shakhas: **Taittiriya**, **Maitrayani**, **Kathaka** (Katha), and **Kapisthala**.

The Four Great Sayings (Mahavakyas)

Mahavakya	Meaning	Upanishad	Veda
Prajnanam Brahma (प्रज्ञानं ब्रह्म)	"Consciousness is Brahman"	**Aitareya**	**Rigveda**
Aham Brahmasmi (अहं ब्रह्मास्मि)	"I am Brahman"	**Brihadaranyaka**	**Shukla Yajurveda**
Tat Tvam Asi (तत्त्वमसि)	"That Thou Art"	**Chhandogya**	**Samaveda**
Ayam Atma Brahma (अयमात्मा ब्रह्म)	"This Self is Brahman"	**Mandukya**	**Atharvaveda**

The Six Vedangas (षडंग — Limbs of the Veda)

Auxiliary sciences to understand the Vedas (all **Smriti**): 1. **Shiksha** (शिक्षा — Phonetics / Pronunciation) 2. **Kalpa** (कल्प — Rituals / Sacrificial procedure: Shrautasutra, Grihyasutra, Dharmasutra, Shulbasutra [geometry of altars]) 3. **Vyakarana** (व्याकरण — Grammar, Panini's *Ashtadhyayi*) 4. **Nirukta** (निरुक्त — Etymology, Yaska's *Nirukta*) 5. **Chandas** (छन्द — Meter / Metrics, Pingala's *Chhandasutra*) 6. **Jyotisha** (ज्योतिष — Astronomy / Auspicious timing, Lagadha's *Vedanga Jyotisha*)

High-Yield Trap Alerts for Prelims

- **Trap 1 (The 2018 Question):** Option "Kathak" in exam questions refers to the **Kathaka recension of Krishna Yajurveda**, NOT the classical dance form Kathak.
- **Trap 2: Gopatha** is the *only* Brahmana of Atharvaveda. If a question asks which Veda does Gopatha belong to → **Atharvaveda**.
- **Trap 3:** *"Satyameva Jayate"* is taken from **Mundaka Upanishad**, NOT Mandukya or Muktika.
- **Trap 4:** Dialogue between **Yama and Nachiketa** on death and immortality is in **Katha Upanishad** (Krishna Yajurveda).
- **Trap 5:** First mention of the **four Ashramas** (Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sannyasa) is in **Jabala Upanishad** (earlier Chandogya only mentioned three).
- **Trap 6:** The legend of **Videha Madhava** (spread of Aryan/Vedic culture towards Bihar across Sadaniira/Gandak river) and the story of the **Deluge (Manu and the fish)** appear in **Shatapatha**

Brahmana.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q13]: Vajasaneyi Samhita** is the Samhita of Shukla Yajurveda. *(See Q11 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

8.4 Epic Literature

Itihasa pair: Ramayana + Mahabharata

- **Ramayana** is by **Valmiki**, the Adikavi. It has **seven kandas** from Bala to Uttara.
- The Sanskrit original is not the same book as regional retellings. Those include Tulsidas *Ramcharitmanas* in Awadhi, Kamban *Ramavataram* in Tamil, and Krittibas in Bengali.
- **Mahabharata** is by **Vyasa**. It has **eighteen parvas**. The inflated count is about 100,000 verses (*shatasahasri*).
- The **Bhagavad Gita** sits in **Bhishma Parva**. It is not a third epic.
- The *Mahabharata* also carries the claim that what is found here may be found elsewhere, but what is not here is found nowhere else.
- **Harivamsha** is a khila (appendix) of the Mahabharata and a Krishna cycle.
- Both epics are **Smriti / itihasa**, not Shruti.

> **Logic:** Gita ≠ a separate Veda. Tulsidas ≠ Valmiki.

8.5 Puranic Literature

There are **18** Mahapuranas and **18** Upapuranas. The names of the eighteen Maha form the usual set.

Pancha-lakshana idea: sarga, pratisarga, vamsha, manvantara, vamshanucharita.

1. Brahma (ब्रह्म)
2. Padma (पद्म)
3. Vishnu (विष्णु)
4. Shiva / Vayu (शिव / वायु) (lists vary on Shiva vs Vayu as a Maha)
5. Bhagavata (भागवत)
6. Narada (नारद)
7. Markandeya (मार्कण्डेय)
8. Agni (अग्नि)
9. Bhavishya (भविष्य)
10. Brahmavaivarta (ब्रह्मवैवर्त)
11. Linga (लिंग)
12. Varaha (वराह)
13. Skanda (स्कन्द) (largest)

14. Vamana (वामन)
15. Kurma (कूर्म)
16. Matsya (मत्स्य)
17. Garuda (गरुड़)
18. Brahmanda (ब्रह्माण्ड)

Purana → dynasty (history use)

Six Puranas carry usable Kali-age king-lists: **Vayu, Brahmanda, Bhagavata, Bhavishya, Matsya, and Vishnu**. Those lists usually **end with the Guptas**. Coaching still matches one Purana to one house.

Purana	Dynasty it is asked for	What it preserves
Vishnu Purana (विष्णु पुराण)	**Maurya** (मौर्य)	Maurya genealogy. The same Magadha chain also names Nanda, Shunga, and Kanva.
Matsya Purana (मत्स्य पुराण)	**Andhra / Satavahana** (सातवाहन)	Longest Andhra list, about **30** kings and about **460** years.
Vayu Purana (वायु पुराण)	**Gupta** (गुप्त) *kings*	Gupta **names**. Also the Kanva end and Andhra founder **Simuka** (सिमुक). It is **not** a Gupta admin manual.
Brahmanda Purana (ब्रह्माण्ड पुराण)	Parallel to Vayu	Andhra and Gupta name-lists sit close to the Vayu recension.
Bhagavata Purana (भागवत पुराण)	Solar–lunar lines + Krishna	Also carries Maurya–Andhra lists. It is the Krishna-bhakti peak text.
Bhavishya Purana (भविष्य पुराण)	"Future" Kali-age kings	Later layers. Use it lightly.
Markandeya Purana (मार्कण्डेय पुराण)	Not a dynasty match	*Devi Mahatmya* (देवी माहात्म्य) sits here.
Skanda Purana (स्कन्द पुराण)	Not a dynasty match	Largest Maha. Tirtha geography, not the Magadha king-list.

- The **Vishnu Purana** (विष्णु पुराण) is the match for the **Maurya** (मौर्य) genealogy.
- The **Matsya Purana** (मत्स्य पुराण) is the match for the **Andhra / Satavahana** (सातवाहन) list.
- The **Vayu Purana** (वायु पुराण) lists **Gupta** (गुप्त) kings. It does **not** throw light on the Gupta system of governance.
- Other Puranas can name the same houses. Do not treat the match as "this Purana alone ever mentions them."

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q29]:** Puranas: 18 Mahapuranas; compiled primarily by Sage Vyasa; five characteristics (Pancha Lakshana: Sarga, Pratisarga, Vamsha, Manvantara, Vamshanucharita). *(See Q6 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

8.6 Regional Literature

Regional literature is the language of the people. Learn each book with its language and region.

Tamil (तमिल) / Sangam (संगम)

- Three Sangams are legendary under **Pandya** (पांड्य) patronage. Traditional seats: **1st Madurai** (मदुरै) (**Agastya** (अगस्त्य)), **2nd Kapadapuram** (कपाटपुरम्) (Agastya), **3rd Madurai** (**Nakkirar** (नक्कीरर)). The corpus is *Ettuttokai* (एट्टुत्तोकै) and *Pattuppattu* (पत्तुप्पाट्टु).
- ***Tolkappiyam*** (तोल्काप्पियम्) by **Tolkappiyar** (तोल्काप्पियर) tradition is the earliest Tamil grammar and poetics.
- **Tiruvalluvar** (तिरुवल्लुवर) wrote *Tirukkural* (तिरुक्कुरल) (*Kural* / **Muppal** (मुप्पाल)), also called the Bible and **Laghuveda** (लघुवेद) of Tamil literature.
- **Ilango Adigal** (इलंगो अडिगल) wrote *Silappadikaram* (शिलप्पदिकारम्) (**Kannagi** (कन्नगी)–**Kovalan** (कोवलन) love tragedy).
- **Sattanar** (सत्तनार) wrote *Manimekalai* (मणिमेकलै) (Buddhist sequel; merchant / nun story).
- **Kamban** (कंबन) wrote *Ramavataram* (रामावतारम्), the Tamil *Ramayana* (रामायण).
- ***Tirumurai*** (तिरुमुरै) is the twelve-volume Saiva hymn corpus; tradition treats it as a **Fifth Veda** of Tamil Shaivism (with Vedas and Saiva Agamas behind Saiva Siddhanta).
- The **12 Alvars** (आलवार) were Tamil Vaishnavite poet-saints whose sacred hymns are compiled in the *Nalayira Divya Prabandham* (नालायिर दिव्य प्रबंधम्).
- The **63 Nayanars** (नायनार) were Tamil Shaivite poet-saints whose foundational hymns comprise the *Tevaram* (तेवारम्) (canonized within the 12 *Tirumurais*).

Match spine (Tamil texts)

Text	Nature
Tirukkural (तिरुक्कुरल)	Philosophy / ethics
Tolkappiyam (तोल्काप्पियम्)	Grammar
Silappadikaram (शिलप्पदिकारम्)	Love / Kannagi story
Manimekalai (मणिमेकलै)	Merchant / Buddhist nun story

Other Dravidian

- The Kannada three gems are **Pampa**, **Ranna** and **Ponna**.
- **Basava** wrote Kannada *vachanas* in the Virashaiva line.
- The Telugu Mahabharata poets are **Nannaya**, **Tikkana** and **Errana**.
- **Tyagaraja** (त्यागराज) wrote Telugu Rama *kritis*. He is of the Carnatic Trinity.
- In Malayalam literature, the earliest notable poetic work is the 12th-century *Ramacharitam*, followed later by the foundational writings of Thunchaththu Ezhuthachan.

Indo-Aryan (UP-heavy)

- **Tulsidas** composed the *Ramcharitmanas* in **Awadhi** across the cultural belt of Ayodhya, Chitrakoot, and Varanasi (Banaras); his other seminal masterworks include *Vinaya Patrika* and *Kavitavali*.

- **Surdas** wrote *Sursagar*, *Sur Saravali*, and *Sahitya Lahiri* in **Braj**. He is in the Vallabhacharya / Pushtimarg line.
- **Kabir** (कबीर) wrote *Bijak* and *sabad*. He is of Maghar / Sant Kabir Nagar in **Uttar Pradesh. His guru is** Ramananda**.
- **Malik Muhammad Jayasi** wrote *Padmavat* in **Awadhi**.
- **Bihari** wrote *Satsai* in Braj.
- **Rahim / Raskhan** wrote Braj Krishna/Hindi couplets in the Mughal age.
- **Bhartendu Harishchandra** of Varanasi is universally regarded as the father of modern Hindi prose and stage drama.
- **Premchand** wrote *Godan*, *Gaban* and *Sevasadan*. He is the **UP** Hindi-Urdu novelist.
- **Jayasi / Kabir / Tulsidas** are the Awadhi–Sant core. **Tulsidas is not** in the Guru Granth Sahib.

Others (name-fact)

- Prominent landmarks of Bengali literature include the early poetry of **Chandidas** and the devotional biographies of Chaitanya Mahaprabhu.
- **Rabindranath Tagore wrote *Gitanjali*. He won the Nobel in** 1913**.
- Marathi Bhakti literature is anchored by **Jnaneshwar** (who authored the *Jnaneshwari* commentary on the Gita) and the devotional *abhangas* of Sant **Tukaram** (तुकाराम).
- Jayadeva is Sanskrit, but Odisha claims the Gita Govinda soil.
- Classical Urdu poetry reached its zenith through master poets **Mirza Ghalib** and **Mir Taqi Mir**, flourishing across the Delhi and Lucknow cultural spheres.
- **Ghazal** (ग़ज़ल) is an Urdu lyric, sung as light-classical.
- Kashmiri literary traditions encompass the mystic verses (*vatsun*) of 14th-century Shaivite poetess **Lal Ded** (Lalleshwari) as well as the Sanskrit master-anthology *Kathasaritsagara* composed by Somadeva in Kashmir.

> **Logic:** Awadhi = Tulsidas/Jayasi. Braj = Surdas. Premchand = UP novel, not a Bhakti sant.

8.7 Indian Languages

Indian languages fall into **Indo-Aryan**, **Dravidian**, **Austroasiatic** (Munda and Santhali), and **Tibeto-Burman** families. Isolates such as Burushaski sit outside this paper.

Eighth Schedule = 22

Assamese, Bengali, Bodo, Dogri, Gujarati, Hindi, Kannada, Kashmiri, Konkani, Maithili, Malayalam, Manipuri, Marathi, Nepali, Odia, Punjabi, Sanskrit, Santhali, Sindhi, Tamil, Telugu, Urdu.

- Languages **not in** the Eighth Schedule include **Bhojpuri**, English and Rajasthani (as a scheduled name).
- Growth ran from 14 in 1950, then Sindhi in 1967 (21st Amendment), then Konkani, Manipuri and Nepali in 1992 (71st), then Bodo, Dogri, Maithili and Santhali in 2003 (92nd), making **22**.
- Sahitya Akademi recognises **24** languages for awards (English and Rajasthani extra). Do not equate that with Schedule 8.

- Language articles are **343–351** in Part XVII. The official language of the Union is Hindi in Devanagari. The Eighth Schedule has **22**.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q102]:** English and Rajasthani are NOT included in the 22 languages of the Eighth Schedule of the Indian Constitution. *(See Q4 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

Classical languages = 11 (not 6)

Language	Year
Tamil	**2004**
Sanskrit	**2005**
Kannada	**2008**
Telugu	**2008**
Malayalam	**2013**
Odia	**2014**
Marathi	**3 Oct 2024**
Pali	**3 Oct 2024**
Prakrit	**3 Oct 2024**
Assamese	**3 Oct 2024**
Bengali	**3 Oct 2024**

- Nodal culture machinery and the LEC sit under **Sahitya Akademi** (साहित्य अकादेमी). Criteria were revised in **July 2024** before the five were added.
- Pali and Prakrit matter for UP (Buddhist/Jain belt) even though they are not Eighth-Schedule names as "Pali/Prakrit."
- **Hindi is not** a classical language.

Institutes

- The **Central Institute of Indian Languages (CIIL)** is at **Mysuru**, not Varanasi and not Delhi.

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q41]: Central Institute of Indian Languages (CIIL)** is located at **Mysuru (Karnataka)**, established 1969. *(See Q10 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q3]:** Babur wrote *Tuzk-e-Babri* in his mother tongue **Chagatai Turki**; Mughal court language was Persian. *(See Q1 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

8.8 Important Literary Works

Home for leftover match-pairs (not already under Sanskrit / regional cards above).

Master author ↔ work spine (raata table)

Author	Work(s)
Panini (पाणिनि)	*Ashtadhyayi* (अष्टाध्यायी)
Patanjali (पतंजलि)	*Mahabhashya* (महाभाष्य)
Yaska (यास्क)	*Nirukta* (निरुक्त)
Katyayana (कात्यायन)	*Varttika* (वार्त्तिक)
Chanakya / Kautilya (चाणक्य / कौटिल्य)	*Arthashastra* (अर्थशास्त्र)
Vatsyayana (वात्स्यायन)	*Kamasutra* (कामसूत्र)
Amarasimha (अमरसिंह)	*Amarakosha* (अमरकोश)
Kalidasa (कालिदास)	*Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्), *Malavikagnimitram* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्), *Vikramorvashiya* (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्); *Raghuvamsha* (रघुवंश), *Kumarasambhava* (कुमारसंभव), *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत), *Ritusamhara* (ऋतुसंहार)
Bhartrihari (भर्तृहरि)	*Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक)
Kalhana (कल्हण)	*Rajatarangini* (राजतरंगिणी)
Bharavi (भारवि)	*Kiratarjuniya* (किरातार्जुनीय)
Magha (माघ)	*Shishupalavadha* (शिशुपालवध)
Sriharsha (श्रीहर्ष)	*Naishadhiyacharita* (नैषधीयचरित)
Dandin (दंडी)	*Dashakumaracharita* (दशकुमारचरित)
Harsha (हर्ष)	*Nagananda* (नागानन्द), *Ratnavali* (रत्नावली), *Priyadarshika* (प्रियदर्शिका)
Rajasekhara (राजशेखर)	*Karpuramanjari* (कर्पूरमंजरी)
Varahamihira (वराहमिहिर)	*Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता), *Panchasiddhantika* (पंचसिद्धांतिका), *Brihat Jataka* (बृहज्जातक)
Vishakhadatta (विशाखदत्त)	*Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस), *Devichandraguptam* (देवीचन्द्रगुप्तम्)
Shudraka (शूद्रक)	*Mrichchhakatika* (मृच्छकटिकम्)
Bilhana (बिल्हण)	*Vikramankadevacharita* (विक्रमांकदेवचरित)
Sarvavarman (सर्ववर्मन)	*Katantra* (कातंत्र)
Vijnaneshwara (विज्ञानेश्वर)	*Mitakshara* (मिताक्षरा)
Jimutavahana (जीमूतवाहन)	*Dayabhaga* (दायाभाग)
Vishnu Sharma (विष्णु शर्मा)	*Panchatantra* (पंचतंत्र)
Bharata Muni (भरत मुनि)	*Natyashastra* (नाट्यशास्त्र)
Bhasa (भास)	*Svapnavasavadattam* (स्वप्नवासवदत्तम्), *Madhyama-vyayoga* (मध्यमव्यायोग)

Author	Work(s)
Ashvaghosha (अश्वघोष)	*Buddhacharita* (बुद्धचरित), *Saundarananda* (सौंदरानंद)
Jayadeva (जयदेव)	*Gita Govinda* (गीत गोविंद)
Bhaskara II (भास्कर द्वितीय)	*Siddhantashiromani* (सिद्धांत शिरोमणि) (*Lilavati* (लीलावती), *Bijaganita* (बीजगणित)…)
Aryabhata (आर्यभट)	*Aryabhatiya* (आर्यभटीय)
Mahendravarman I (महेन्द्रवर्मन प्रथम)	*Mattavilasa Prahasana* (मत्तविलास प्रहसन)
Vakpati (वाकपति)	*Gaudavaho* (गौडवहो)
Kamandaka (कामंदक)	*Nitisara* (नीतिसार)
Surdas (सूरदास)	*Sursagar* (सूरसागर), *Sur Saravali* (सूरसरावली), *Sahitya Lahiri* (साहित्य लहरी)
Tulsidas (तुलसीदास)	*Ramcharitmanas* (रामचरितमानस), *Vinaya Patrika* (विनय पत्रिका), *Kavitavali* (कवितावली)

- **Tuzuk-i-Baburi / Baburnama** is by Babur in Chagatai Turki. The later Persian translation is by Abdur Rahim.
- **Suka Saptati** is Sanskrit by Chintamani Bhatta. The Persian ***Tutinama*** is by **Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi**, not Amir Khusrau. Akbar's *Tuti-nama* is the Mughal manuscript painting of the same stories.
- Firoz Tughlaq's Nagarkot / Jwalamukhi library haul became the Persian *Dalail-i-Firoz Shahi* by **Azizuddin Khan** (Izaz-ud-din Khalid Khani).
- **Kavindra Acharya Saraswati** of **Banaras** had **Shah Jahan** as patron.
- The **Jnanpith Award** began in **1965**. It is the highest Indian literary prize. The first winner is **G. Sankara Kurup**.
- The **Sahitya Akademi Award** is annual from **1955**. The Akademi was founded in **1954**. Awards cover **24** languages.
- Among common musical instruments, the **veena** is the most ancient in Indian culture; sitar, sarod, and tabla are later medieval introductions.
- The *Mahabharata* carries the famous claim that what is here may be found elsewhere, but what is not here is found nowhere else. The *Bhagavad Gita* carries the karma-yoga line on right to action without claim on fruits.
- Paramara history sources include **Padmagupta** (पद्मगुप्त)'s *Navasahasankacharita* (नवसाहसांकचरित), **Merutunga** (मेरुतुंग)'s *Prabandha Chintamani* (प्रबंध चिंतामणि), and the **Udaipur Prashasti** (उदयपुर प्रशस्ति).
- *Lalitavigraharaja* drama is linked with **Somadeva**. The *Vayu Purana* remembers the Mahanadi under the ancient name **Nilotpala**.
- Rajasthani raso traps: *Prithviraj Raso*–**Chand Bardai**; *Bisaldeva Raso*–**Narapati**; *Khuman Raso*–**Dalpat Vijay** (not Karnidan); *Shatrusal Raso*–**Dungar Singh**.

> **Logic:** Tutinama translator = **Nakhshabi**, not Khusrau. Banaras Sanskrit patron of that PYQ = **Shah Jahan**.
>
> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q43]: Zia Nakhshabi** translated Chintamani Bhatt's Sanskrit text *Shukasaptati* into Persian as *Tutinama* (Book of the Parrot). *(See Q8 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q37]: Azizuddin Khan (Aazz-ud-Din Khalid Khani)** translated 300 volumes of Sanskrit books from Nagarkot (Jwalamukhi temple library) into Persian as *Dalail-i-Firoz Shahi* on orders of Firoz Shah Tughluq. *(See Q7 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*
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> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q146]: Shah Jahan** patronised Kavindra Acharya Saraswati of Banaras, who successfully persuaded the Emperor to abolish the pilgrim tax on Banaras and Allahabad. *(See Q9 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*
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> [!TIP] **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q87]:** Nepal-India International Sanskrit Conclave-2024 held in Kathmandu, organised jointly by Niti Anusandhan Pratisthan Nepal and Central Sanskrit University Delhi. *(See Q5 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*
